

August 12, 2026

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department
P.O. Box 100300
Columbia, SC 29202

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Sammie Zemlak (MRN MUSC3070109), Claim MUSC-20250921-7D92-2

Patient	Sammie Zemlak (DOB 1959-01-28)
MRN	MUSC3070109
Member ID / Group	BCB250343600 / GRP-96407
Claim number	MUSC-20250921-7D92-2
Date of service	2025-09-21
Procedure billed	CPT 71046 — Radiologic examination, chest; 2 views
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$304.79
Denial code	CARC 29 / RARC N211 — The time limit for filing has expired.
Appeal deadline	2026-01-31

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center respectfully submits this formal appeal on behalf of patient Sammie Zemlak (MRN: MUSC3070109, Member ID: BCB250343600, Group: GRP-96407) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20250921-7D92-2 for services rendered on September 21, 2025. BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina denied the claim on November 2, 2025, citing CARC 29 ("The time limit for filing has expired") with accompanying RARC N211 ("You may not appeal this decision") and the payer remark that the claim was received after the contractual filing deadline. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests full reconsideration and payment of the allowed amount of \$215.94.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

On September 21, 2025, Mr. Zemlak, a 67-year-old male with an established history of chronic congestive heart failure, anemia, hypertension, and prediabetes, presented to the MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center Emergency Department (Place of Service 23). Dr. James H. Ferrell, MD (NPI 1992837465) evaluated the patient and ordered a two-view chest radiograph (CPT 71046) under primary diagnosis J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified) with secondary diagnosis D64.9 (Anemia, unspecified). Given Mr. Zemlak's active cardiac and hematologic comorbidities, a chest X-ray in the emergency setting represents a standard, medically appropriate diagnostic tool. The claim was submitted to BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina on October 1, 2025, ten days following the date of service.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial on grounds of untimely filing is not supported by the facts of this claim. The claim was submitted on October 1, 2025, just ten calendar days after the September 21, 2025 date of service. This submission interval is well within any standard contractual timely filing window recognized in the industry, which typically ranges from 90 days to one year from the date of service for participating providers. MUSC Health maintains that the claim was submitted in a timely and compliant manner and requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina provide the specific contractual provision and the precise deadline date upon which it is relying to support the CARC 29 denial.

Regarding RARC N211, which states that this decision may not be appealed, MUSC Health respectfully notes that providers retain the right to seek reconsideration of claim determinations, particularly when the factual basis for the denial is disputed. The payer's own remittance advice identifies an appeal deadline of January 31, 2026, and instructs providers to submit reconsideration through My Insurance Manager with supporting documentation attached — a process this letter initiates. The inclusion of RARC N211 alongside an explicit appeal deadline creates an internal inconsistency in the denial notice, and MUSC Health proceeds on the basis that reconsideration is both permitted and appropriate.

MUSC Health has enclosed the remittance advice dated November 2, 2025, and relevant medical records supporting the medical necessity of CPT 71046 as billed. The billed charge of \$304.79 reflects the facility's standard charges, and the payer's own adjudication established an allowed amount of \$215.94, confirming the service falls within covered benefits. The sole basis for zero payment is the disputed timely filing assertion, not any question of coverage, medical necessity, or coding accuracy.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina reverse the timely filing denial for Claim MUSC-20250921-7D92-2, reprocess the claim on its merits, and issue payment of the allowed amount of \$215.94 to MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center. Should the payer require additional documentation to support this reconsideration, we welcome the opportunity to provide it promptly through My Insurance Manager.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record